PROPOSAL FOR REVIEW

# Your Own Trading Journal

A private, Tradezella-style journal built around how you actually trade: Pepperstone execution, TradingView charts, and forex-specific stats. This document shows how it would work and lists the decisions we need from you before we start.

Prepared by Felix Makinda
23 October 2026
Version 1 (for discussion)

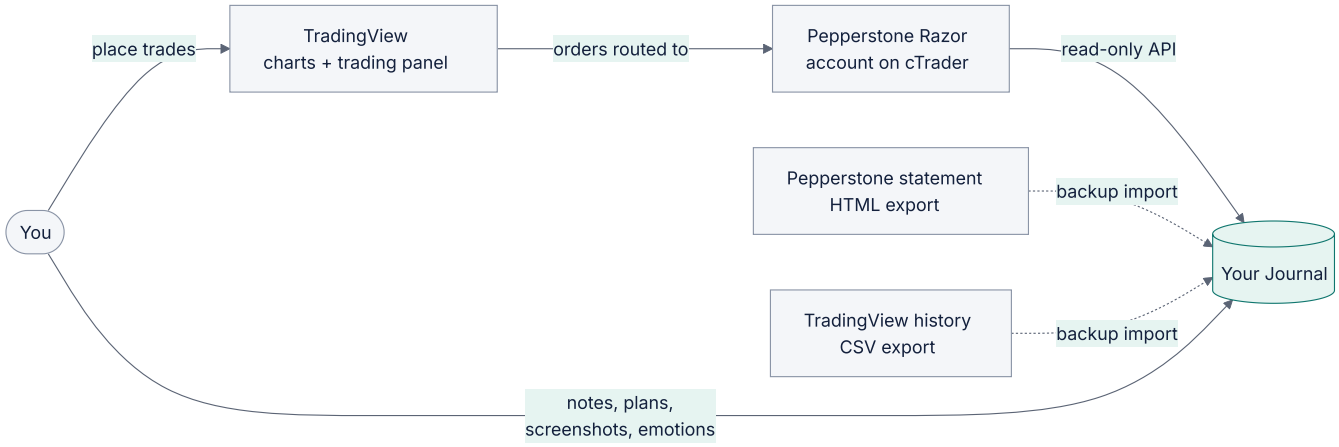
# 1. Why build it instead of paying for one

You want something you own, can personalise, and do not pay for every month. Here is what is on the market today.

| Option | Price | What we noticed |
|---|---|---|
| **Tradezella** | $35 / $59 / $99 per month (new 2026 tiers) | Polished, but no free trial and no refunds. Reviewers mention syncs that break, filters that reset, and AI auto-tagging that messed up stats. Built mainly for US stocks and futures. |
| **ETW Journal** | $7 / $15 per month | Cheap and supports cTrader, but big promises ("serious edge", "your data is safe") with no detail on how the AI works or how data is protected. |
| **Open-source journals** (TradeNote, Deltalytix) | Free, self-hosted | Good starting ideas, but aimed at stocks and futures, not forex. No Pepperstone or prop-firm features. |
| **Ours** | Roughly $0 to $7 per month to run | Built for one person (you), for forex, for Pepperstone and TradingView. You own all the data and can export it any time. |

## The key discovery

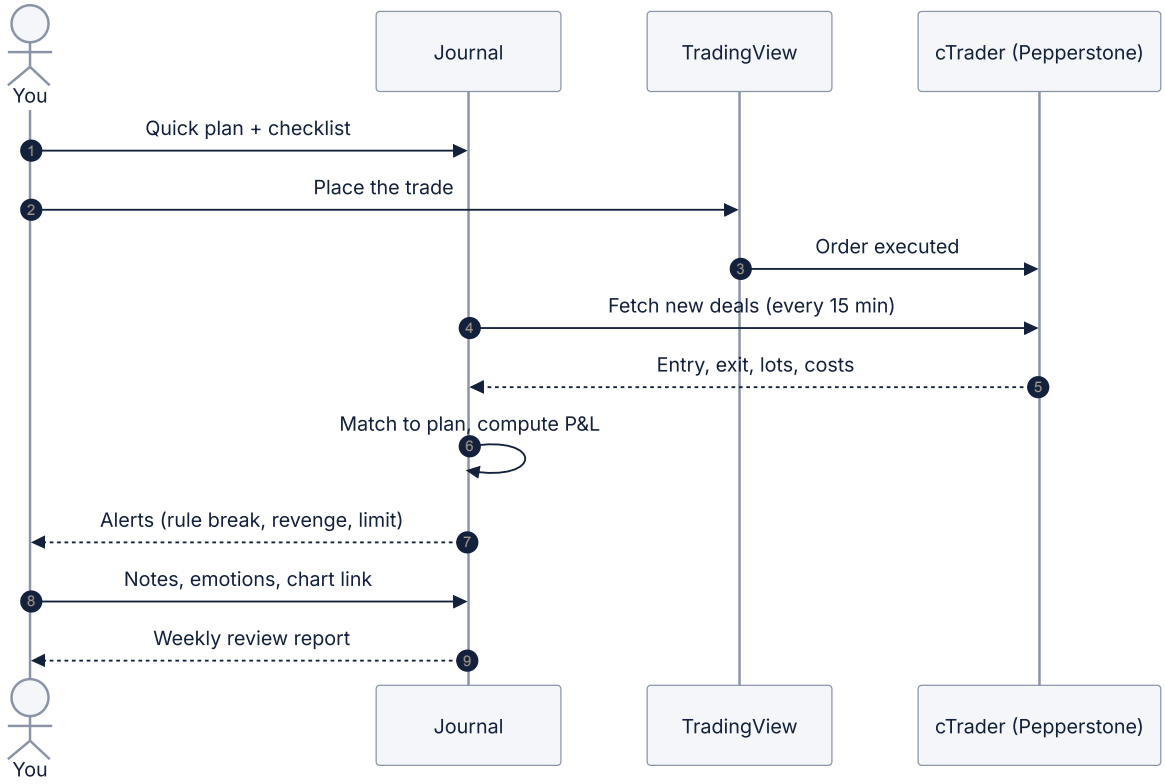
Pepperstone only lets you trade on TradingView through a **Razor account on cTrader**. That means your trades actually live inside cTrader, and cTrader has an official, free API. So the journal can **pull your trades in automatically** with read-only access. No CSV uploads, no typing entries by hand.




Solid arrows are the automatic path. Dotted arrows are backups if the automatic sync is ever unavailable.

## 2. How a normal trading day would flow

The journal fits around your routine instead of adding work to it.




| Step | What happens |
|---|---|
| 1 | Before the trade you jot a quick plan: setup, entry, stop, target, and tick your checklist. Optional. |
| 2-3 | You trade on TradingView as usual. The order executes on your Pepperstone Razor account in cTrader. |
| 4-5 | Every 15 minutes the journal fetches new deals (read-only), including commission and swap. |
| 6-7 | It matches the trade to your plan, computes P&L in $, pips and R, and flags rule breaks, revenge trades or a nearby daily loss limit. |
| 8-9 | You add emotions, notes and a TradingView snapshot link. At the end of the week you get a review report (with an AI summary later). |

### What "matching to your plan" gives you

- A **rule score** per trade: did you follow your checklist, respect your stop, size correctly?
- A clear split between **good trades that lost** (followed the plan) and **bad trades that won** (broke the rules but got lucky). This is where most improvement comes from.
- Plans are optional. If you skip one, the trade still syncs and shows up as "unplanned".

## 3. What the journal would do

Grouped by priority. Phase 1-3 is the first usable version. Later comes after you have used it for a while.

### Core journal Phase 1-2

- Trade list with filters (pair, session, setup, tag, date)
- Calendar of daily P&L
- Dashboard: win rate, average win and loss, profit factor, expectancy, drawdown
- Notes, tags, screenshots, TradingView snapshot links shown as images
- Export everything to CSV or JSON at any time

### Automatic sync Phase 3

- Connect your cTrader ID once, read-only
- New trades appear within about 15 minutes
- Commission and swap included, so P&L matches Pepperstone
- Backup: import Pepperstone statements or TradingView CSV

### Forex-specific Phase 4

- Results in dollars, pips and **R** (multiples of what you risked)
- Session stats: Asia, London, New York, shown in Nairobi time
- Best and worst pairs, days and hours
- Prop-firm tracker: daily drawdown and max loss with warnings (if you trade funded accounts)

### Behaviour and psychology Phase 4

- Revenge trade alert: bigger lot soon after a loss
- Overtrading and losing-streak (tilt) detection
- Mood, sleep and emotion tags compared with results
- Your own rules, tracked and scored

### AI coach Later

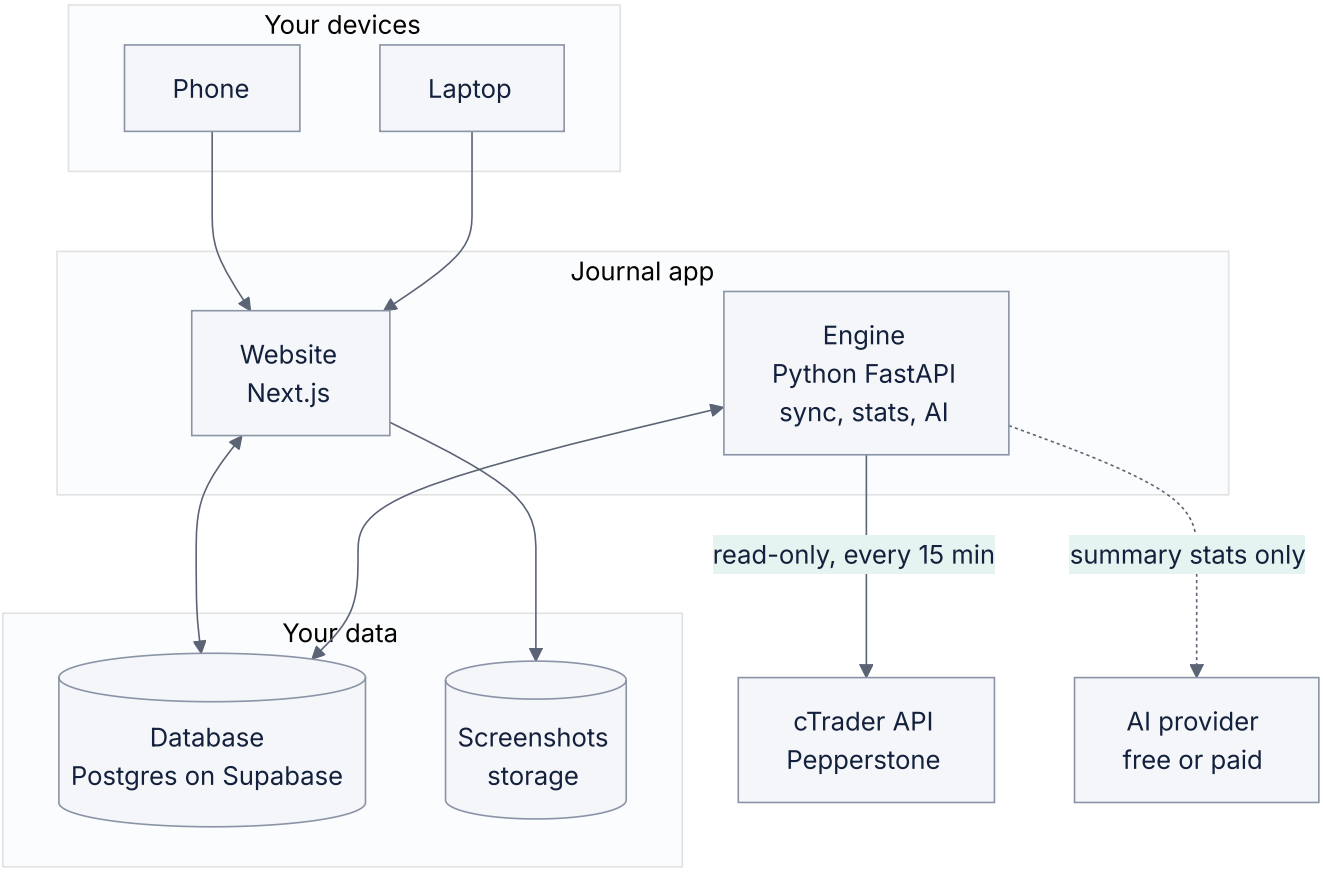
- Weekly review written from your real numbers
- "Ask my journal": e.g. *Why do I lose on Fridays?*
- Choose free, paid, or fully private AI (see section 5)

### Phone friendly Later

- Install on your phone like an app (no app store needed)
- Log a note or emotion in about 10 seconds

## 4. How it is built (the short version)

You do not need to manage any of this. It is here so you can see where your data goes.



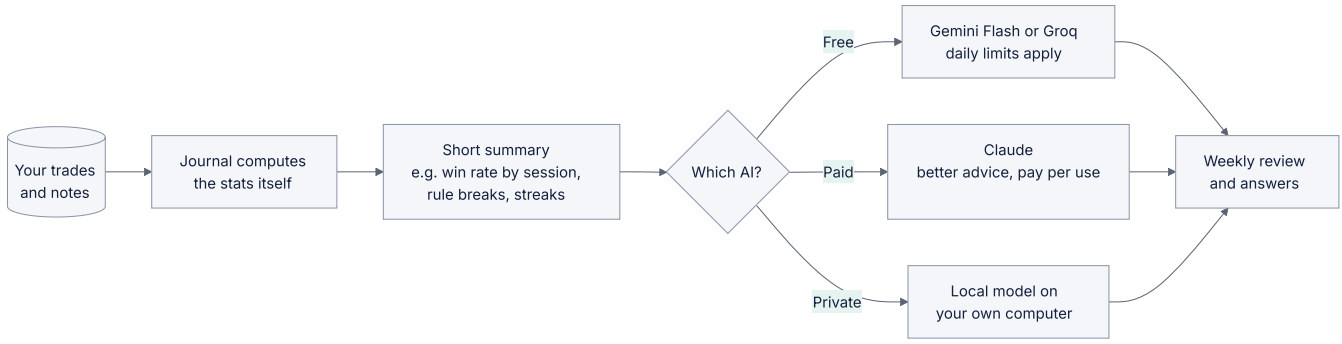

### Where should it live?

| | Online (recommended) | Only on your computer |
|---|---|---|
| Access from phone | Yes, anywhere | Only at home, on that machine |
| Automatic trade sync | Runs even when your laptop is off | Only while your computer is on |
| Backups | Automatic daily backups | Your responsibility |
| Privacy | Locked to your login, with 2-step verification | Never leaves your machine |
| Monthly cost | About $0 to $7 | $0 (electricity aside) |

Either way, the same app works both ways. If you start online and later want it only on your computer, we move it with one export and one command.

# 5. AI coach and keeping your data safe

## How the AI would work (later phase)




- **The AI never does the maths.** The journal calculates every number, and the AI only explains it. That stops it from inventing figures.
- **It sees summaries, not your account.** No login details, balances or account numbers are sent.
- **You can switch AI provider** in settings, with a monthly spending cap. Free tiers have daily limits that change often, so the journal keeps working when a limit is hit.

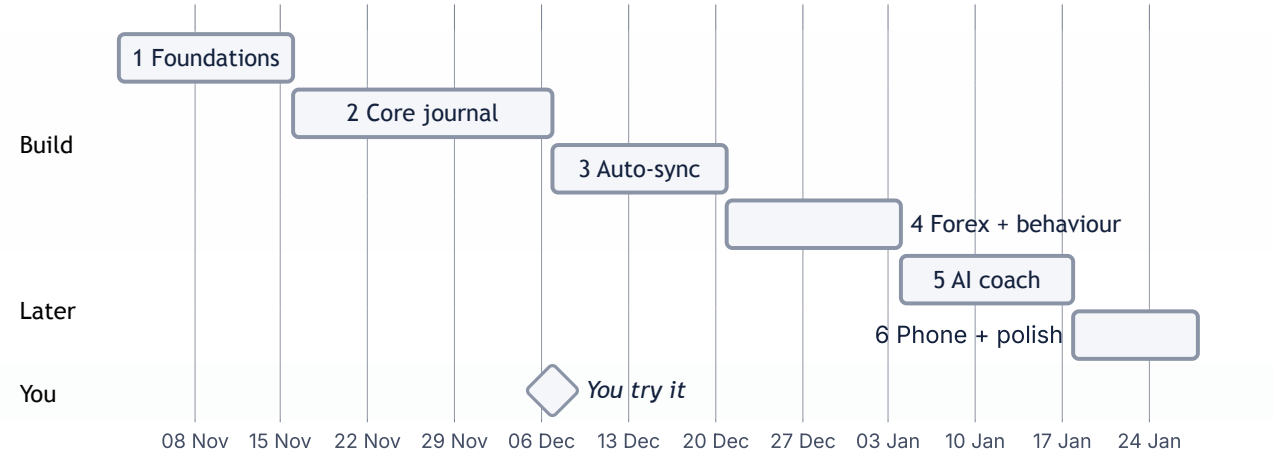
## Security, in plain terms

- **Read-only broker access.** The journal can see trades but can never place, change or close one, and can never withdraw.
- The cTrader connection key is **encrypted** and never sent to your browser.
- Login with **2-step verification**. Every row of data is locked to your account at database level.
- Automatic daily backups, plus a full export button.
- Every code change is automatically tested and scanned for security problems before it goes live.

**Note:** the journal records and analyses. It does not give trade signals or place trades. The AI's suggestions are reflections on your own history, not financial advice.

## 6. Timeline

An estimate, assuming part-time work. You get something usable at the end of Phase 2 and can give feedback from there.




### What you would need to provide

- A few recent Pepperstone statements (or TradingView history exports) so we can test with real data.
- About 15 minutes to connect your cTrader ID once the sync is ready.
- Your trading rules and setups, so we can build your checklist.
- Honest feedback after Phase 2.

## 7. Decisions we need from you

Tick or write your answer next to each one. Our recommendation is in bold.

| # | Question | Options | Your answer |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Do you trade through TradingView using a Pepperstone **Razor account on cTrader**? Any MT4 or MT5 accounts as well? | Yes, cTrader only / Also MT4 or MT5 / Not sure | |
| 2 | How should trades come in? | **Automatic read-only cTrader sync** / Manual statement uploads only | |
| 3 | Where should the journal live? | **Online (phone + laptop)** / Only on my computer | |
| 4 | Do you trade prop-firm or funded accounts? If yes, which firm and what are the drawdown rules? | Yes (details) / No | |
| 5 | Will you write a short plan before trades? | **Yes, quick checklist** / Sometimes / No, journal after only | |
| 6 | AI coach preference | **Start free, switch to paid if useful** / Paid from the start / Private only (local) | |
| 7 | Monthly budget for hosting and AI | $0 / **Up to $10** / More | |
| 8 | Account currency and the sessions you trade | e.g. USD; London and New York | |
| 9 | Top 3 features you want first (from section 3) | Your pick | |
| 10 | Anything Tradezella or other journals do that you love, or that annoys you? | Free text | |

Once we have these answers, we will confirm the plan and start Phase 1.